

“ **Music** ... [establishes] an **order in things** including, and particularly, the **coordination** between **man** and **time**. ”

IGOR STRAVINSKY, 1935

The year 1939 brought personal tragedy: Stravinsky's mother, youngest daughter, and wife Catherine all died within a few months. For many years, he had been in a relationship with the younger Vera Sudeikina, a painter and costume designer and, like him, a Russian exile. With World War II looming, they moved to the US, married, became US citizens, and settled in Hollywood, making friends with European fellow emigrants or refugees. Earning the kind of income that Stravinsky was used to was difficult: several film-score projects fell through, but he was able to recycle music already written into his concert works. A major achievement of this kind, completed in 1945, was *Symphony in Three Movements*, with its brassy, US-influenced style and propulsive rhythmic invention.

Late change of style

Four years of work were taken up by a full-length opera, *The Rake's Progress*, based on drawings by William Hogarth, with a libretto by English and US poets W.H. Auden and Chester Kallman. Early progress on another opera, to a projected text by Dylan Thomas, was ended a few years later by the Welsh poet's